

CreativEX 2026

City Branding & Creative Organization

Speaker 1 Knowledge Set

UNESCO Perspective on Thai Creative Cities and Sustainable Urban Identity

Easy takeaway

A Creative City is not a trophy. It is a long-term promise to use culture, creativity and cooperation to build a city where local people can live with dignity, identity and future opportunities.



ORGANIZED BY: CEA, Chula, CHULALONGKORN BUSINESS SCHOOL, TCEB. SUPPORTED BY: NIA.

CreativEX 2026

City Branding & Creative Organization
การสร้างแบรนด์เมืองและองค์กรสร้างสรรค์

วันศุกร์ ที่ 19 มิถุนายน 2569
ณ ห้อง CBS Cinema อาคารโยทยศสมบัติ 1 ชั้น 3 จุฬาลงกรณ์มหาวิทยาลัย
Dress Code : ชุดสุภาพ

12.00 - 13.00	ลงทะเบียน และรับประทานอาหารกลางวัน ที่ อาคารโยทยศสมบัติ 3 ชั้น 1
Lecture 13.00 - 14.30	UNESCO Perspective on Thai Creative Cities and Sustainable Urban Identity โดย Dr. Feng Jing Chief of Culture Unit, UNESCO Bangkok
14.30 - 14.45	PM Break
Lecture 14.45 - 16.00	Driving Enterprise Competitiveness: Building a Tech-Driven Creative Organization โดย คุณณัฏฐ์ อนุโสมวนิต ประธานเจ้าหน้าที่บริหาร SEA (ประเทศไทย)
Lecture 16.00 - 18.00	UK Creative Industries: Case Study of Success โดย Ms. Rehana Mughal ผู้อำนวยการด้านเศรษฐกิจสร้างสรรค์ จาก British Council

ACADEMIC PARTNERS: UNESCO, TCEB

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Speaker: Dr. Feng Jing

Chief of Culture Unit, UNESCO Bangkok

Lecture slot: 13:00 - 14:30 | Friday, 19 June 2026

1. How to read this document quickly

This document is not a word-for-word transcript. It translates, expands and organizes the key ideas from Speaker 1 into a practical knowledge set that can be used for reports, presentations, project design and city branding discussions.

5-minute read

Start with the Executive Summary and the 4R model to grasp the core argument immediately.

For reports

Use the Creative Corridors section and the checklist as policy or project-design material.

15-minute read

Read the synthesized transcript and key concepts to understand the lecture in context.

For slides

Turn Root - Route - Role - Responsibility into a simple storytelling structure.

2. Executive Summary - one-page version

Main argument

Thai creative cities should move beyond isolated city branding and become connected cultural-creative corridors that link cities, people, knowledge, markets and futures.

- UNESCO designations should not be treated as prizes. They are long-term responsibilities.
- The lesson from the Silk Roads is that culture grows through exchange, not isolation.
- Thai cities should not be seen as separate islands of creativity. They can be connected as corridors of crafts, gastronomy, design, learning and civic innovation.
- A real creative city must connect culture, economy, environment, local institutions and citizen participation.
- The goal is not only to make a city look attractive or sell well. The deeper goal is to help people live well, protect local identity and participate in the global creative economy.

Core question	Simple answer
What is a Creative City?	A city that uses culture, creativity and creative industries as tools for sustainable urban development.
What does UNESCO emphasize?	Cooperation among cities, local participation, knowledge exchange and the integration of culture into urban development plans.
What is the common risk?	Turning Creative City into a marketing label, a tourism campaign or a decorative title without long-term systems behind it.
What is the main lesson?	Know the city roots, then connect those roots with other cities to create larger shared value.

3. Synthesized transcript from the lecture

Transcription note

The available source file covers the closing part of the lecture and contains automatic transcription errors. For clarity, place names were corrected according to context: Puke = Phuket, Pechaburi = Phetchaburi, Sunkara = Songkhla, Sokotai = Sukhothai.

The speaker explains that heritage and culture should not be treated as static properties or isolated assets. They should be understood as living systems of relationships that connect places, people, scientific documentation, governance and international cooperation.

The idea of a corridor is important because it helps us see that culture moves, exchanges and grows through networks. The Silk Roads are a powerful example. They were not only routes for silk, spices or glass. They also carried ideas, technologies, knowledge systems and ways of living together across different cultures.

The lasting legacy of the Silk Roads was not only trade. It included the movement of knowledge such as papermaking, printing, engineering, irrigation and medicine. In this sense, cultural exchange produced innovation.

In the 21st century, the UNESCO Creative Cities Network can be understood as a modern cultural and creative route. It is not a route of camels or ships, but a route of data, standards, institutions, knowledge, creative markets and city-to-city cooperation.

From this point of view, cities such as Nan, Chiang Mai, Sukhothai, Phuket, Phetchaburi, Songkhla and Bangkok should not be treated as isolated islands of creativity. They can be linked as corridors: for example, a northern crafts corridor or a gastronomy and coastal culture corridor.

The speaker emphasizes that UNESCO global designations - World Heritage sites, biosphere reserves, intangible cultural heritage elements, Creative Cities, learning cities or geoparks - are not trophies to be won and forgotten. They are long-term responsibilities toward ancestors, future generations and the global community.

Thai creative cities should therefore move beyond superficial urban branding. They should use UNESCO tools such as cultural conventions, the Historic Urban Landscape approach and the Creative Cities Network framework to map layered identities, strengthen local institutions and empower civil society.

4. Knowledge Set 1 - A Creative City is a system, not a label

Creative City is often misunderstood as a city with beautiful festivals, famous food, attractive crafts, cool design or a memorable logo. In the UNESCO perspective, however, a Creative City is a development system that places culture and creativity at the center of urban policy and everyday life.

Surface-level view	UNESCO-oriented view
What famous product does the city have?	How does that cultural asset connect with the lives of local people?
Launch a tourism campaign.	Integrate culture into urban development planning.
Sell the city image.	Build culture, economy and quality of life together.
Let cities compete alone.	Let cities cooperate, exchange and learn from each other.
Focus mainly on visitors.	Focus on residents, creators, communities and visitors.

Remember this

A good Creative City should be able to answer: How does creativity make life better for people in the city? Not only: What can we sell?

5. Knowledge Set 2 - Silk Roads: culture grows through connection

The speaker uses the Silk Roads as a metaphor. Cultural greatness does not come from one city being excellent by itself. It comes from the movement of goods, knowledge, people, technologies and languages.

What people often remember	The deeper lesson
Silk, spices, glass and high-value commodities.	Ideas, technologies, sciences and ways of thinking that travelled across cultures.
A trade route.	A space for dialogue and exchange among civilizations.
Movement of objects.	Movement of knowledge and innovation.
A story of the past.	A model for future creative cities.

Simple translation

A city does not have to become famous alone. It should understand how its strengths can connect with other cities to create bigger value.

6. Knowledge Set 3 - From local pride to cultural corridors

Local pride is a good starting point. But if a city stops there, it may become isolated. The speaker invites Thai cities to shift from individual city branding toward connected cultural and creative corridors.

1) Northern Crafts Corridor Nan - Chiang Mai - Sukhothai - Chiang Rai Connect craft, textiles, folk art, Buddhist art, local artisans and younger designers.	2) Gastronomy & Coastal Corridor Phuket - Phetchaburi - Songkhla Connect food heritage, local ingredients, coastal agriculture, fisheries, marine ecosystems and responsible food tourism.
3) Design & Urban Innovation Corridor Bangkok - Chiang Rai and other creative cities Connect design, contemporary art, public space, urban services and local innovation.	4) Learning & Civic Corridor Connect universities, communities, businesses, public agencies and youth so that creative city work belongs to everyone.

Examples of possible projects

- Build shared databases of artisans, ingredients, creative spaces and city stories.
- Create quality and ethics standards for cultural products, such as fair payment, respectful use of patterns and transparent production.
- Design learning-based tourism routes, not only check-in routes or souvenir shopping routes.
- Organize residencies and exchanges among artists, artisans, chefs, designers and researchers across cities.
- Develop shared markets, such as online marketplaces, showcases, festival circuits and city-to-city fairs.
- Create joint research agendas, such as food and climate resilience, crafts and youth employment, or historic towns and creative economy.

7. Knowledge Set 4 - Historic Urban Landscape: old cities are not frozen objects

The Historic Urban Landscape, or HUL, helps historic cities move beyond the narrow idea of old buildings, monuments or photo backdrops. It encourages cities to see heritage as a living landscape made of people, memories, economy, everyday practices, environment and change.

Common trap	How HUL helps
Preserving so strictly that the city becomes frozen and younger generations cannot live there.	Connect heritage conservation with quality of life and urban economy.
Developing so quickly that the city loses its identity.	Assess cultural values before designing change.
Treating old towns as landmarks only.	See the city as a relationship among place, people and memory.
Tourism grows, but local people are pushed out.	Design policies that allow local people to benefit and remain in place.

Key idea

A sustainable city is not a city that never changes. It is a city that can change without destroying its own meaning.

Questions a city should ask before development

- Whose memories are embedded in this place?
- Do local residents still use this space in daily life?
- Who benefits from the new development, and who may lose access or space?
- Which cultural practices are still living, and which are being reduced to display objects?
- How can the city generate income without losing the spirit of the place?

8. The 4R Model for Thai Creative Cities

To make the lecture easier to apply, the key ideas can be organized into a practical 4R model.

R1 - Root Understand the city cultural roots: geography, history, livelihoods, beliefs, skills, memories and everyday life.	R2 - Route Connect those roots into routes of knowledge, tourism, markets and city-to-city cooperation.
R3 - Role Define the city role in a wider network: craft city, food city, design city, music city, learning city or policy-lab city.	R4 - Responsibility Take responsibility for local people, artisans, young creators, the environment and future generations.

Step	Diagnostic question	Expected output
Root	Which living cultural roots does the city still have?	A cultural asset map and a map of knowledge holders.
Route	Which cities should it connect with, and around what theme?	Routes, networks and joint projects.
Role	What role should the city play in the creative network?	A clear positioning that does not isolate the city.
Responsibility	Who must benefit, and what must not be damaged?	Indicators for people, communities, environment and economy.

Shortest memory aid
Root = know the roots | Route = build connections | Role = clarify the role | Responsibility = care for the future

9. Applying the idea to Thai creative cities

The examples below extend the speaker ideas into possible applications. The point is to see Thai creative cities as a connected system, not as separate campaigns.

City or corridor	Cultural root	Possible application
Nan - Chiang Mai - Sukhothai - Chiang Rai	Crafts, folk art, historic towns, artisan communities and Buddhist art.	Create a northern craft knowledge platform, learning routes and designer-artisan residencies.
Phuket - Phetchaburi - Songkhla	Food heritage, local ingredients, coastal agriculture, fisheries and port-city cultures.	Create a research kitchen linking chefs, fishers, farmers and researchers for sustainable local cuisine.
Bangkok - Chiang Rai	Design, contemporary art, creative markets and experimental urban spaces.	Use design to improve walkability, signage, public space, old-town management and accessibility.
Suphan Buri and music networks	Music, storytelling, performance knowledge and cultural workers.	Develop sound archives, local music festivals, youth curricula and creative media training.

What to be careful about

- Do not use culture only as a backdrop for tourism.
- Do not leave artisans and cultural workers underpaid while others capture the value.
- Do not let creative development make the city too expensive for local people to remain.
- Do not replace long-term systems with logos, events or short campaigns.
- Do not treat Creative City work as a government-only task. It requires public agencies, private sector, communities, universities and citizens.

10. Checklist for designing a Creative City project

Use this page as a practical checklist for project design, reports or policy proposals.

Dimension	Check question
Identity	Is the identity based on real local life, or is it only a marketing image?
People	Do artisans, artists, chefs, entrepreneurs, communities, youth and vulnerable groups have real roles?
Evidence	Is there data, cultural mapping, research or documentation behind the decision?
Network	How does the project connect cities, institutions, communities, markets and knowledge?
Economy	Does income reach the actual creators and local communities, or is it captured by only a few actors?
Environment	How does the project affect the environment, water, food systems, old towns and public space?
Governance	Is there a lasting mechanism after the event or campaign ends?
Learning	Is there a system for documentation, evaluation, knowledge sharing and improvement?

Suggested indicators

People Number of meaningful participants, creator income, community satisfaction and youth access.	Culture Knowledge documented, skills transmitted, intellectual heritage protected and culture used respectfully.
Economy Local revenue distribution, new creative businesses and continuity of markets after the event.	Urban quality Public space quality, heritage protection, environmental impact and the ability of local people to remain in place.

11. Ready-to-use presentation structure

This structure can become an 8-10 slide presentation. It moves from problem, to concept, to application, to action.

Slide	Topic	Core message
1	Creative City is not a label	It is an urban development system, not only a brand or campaign.
2	Lesson from the Silk Roads	Cultural prosperity comes from exchange and connection.
3	The problem of isolated cities	Separate city branding misses opportunities to create shared value.
4	Creative Corridors	Connect cities into routes of knowledge, markets and creative culture.
5	Thai examples	Nan-Chiang Mai-Sukhothai, Phuket-Phetchaburi-Songkhla, Bangkok-Chiang Rai.
6	Historic Urban Landscape	Historic cities must develop without destroying local meaning and everyday life.
7	The 4R Model	Root, Route, Role and Responsibility as a practical framework.
8	Action agenda	Build databases, connect networks, create permanent mechanisms and measure people, culture, economy and urban quality.

Possible closing sentence

A great Creative City is not the city that sells its past most effectively. It is the city that uses its roots to build a future where local people still want to live.

12. Glossary - key terms in simple language

Term	Simple meaning
UNESCO Creative Cities Network	A network of cities that use creativity and culture as strategic tools for sustainable urban development.
Sustainable Urban Identity	A living city identity that is connected to local people and can coexist with development.
Creative Corridor	A connection among cities that links knowledge, culture, markets and shared projects.
Historic Urban Landscape	A holistic way of seeing historic cities through buildings, people, memory, economy and environment.
Local Pride	A useful starting point, but it should lead to cooperation and real local benefit.
Civic Participation	Real involvement of citizens and civil society in shaping the city, not only listening after decisions are made.
Cultural Economy	An economy built from culture, knowledge, creativity and heritage, while respecting the people who carry that culture.

13. Reference notes

- Source transcript: 01.docx provided by the user. The file contains the closing part of Speaker 1 and was transcribed by Transkriptor.
- UNESCO - Creative Cities Network: created in 2004 to promote cooperation among cities that identify creativity as a strategic factor for sustainable urban development. Source: <https://www.unesco.org/en/creative-cities>
- UNESCO - World Cities Day 2025 article: after 58 new designations, the UCCN includes 408 cities across more than 100 countries. Source: <https://www.unesco.org/en/articles/world-cities-day-2025-unesco-creative-cities-network-welcomes-58-new-member-cities>
- UNESCO World Heritage Centre - Recommendation on the Historic Urban Landscape: a holistic approach to managing historic urban areas. Source: <https://whc.unesco.org/en/hul/>
- UNESCO - Silk Roads Programme: the Silk Roads as Routes of Dialogue for understanding commercial, cultural and scientific exchanges. Source: <https://www.unesco.org/en/silkroads/about-programme>
- Tourism Authority of Thailand Newsroom - Nan and Songkhla named UNESCO Creative Cities for 2025. Source: <https://www.tatnews.org/2025/11/nan-and-songkhla-named-unesco-creative-cities-for-2025/>

Important note

This document is a synthesized knowledge set, not a complete verbatim transcript. It translates, clarifies and expands the ideas based on the available lecture excerpt and supporting UNESCO references.

14. Final synthesis

The heart of Speaker 1 is an invitation to understand Thai creative cities more deeply than image-making. A city should not stop at saying: we have something special. It must show how that special cultural value helps local people live better, protects identity and connects the city to the world with dignity.

Three-line summary

- 1) Know the city roots.
- 2) Connect cities as networks, not isolated competitors.
- 3) Use creativity for the future of local people, not only for short-term image.

Therefore, Creative City designation is not the end point. It is the beginning of shared responsibility among government, private sector, communities, universities and citizens to build cities with meaning, economy and sustainable futures.